

OREGON CITY COURIER

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THE GREAT DRIVE

The most popular pastime in America is the "great drive." In view of the fact that Clackamas county people are daily called upon for donations to unworthy war funds it is timely that The Courier inject a repeated word of advice.

How fine it would be if we could devote every dollar we could spare to the purchase of Liberty bonds and thrift stamps, and to do free giving to the Red Cross and the Y. M. C. A. If there is a balance for donations on our books it might be well to aid the Y. M. C. A.

So might it be! But in the offing appear our old friends graft and greed, the pigs of the "great drive." Not content with seeking worthy work done these pigs seek profit from the coin of our prosperity. They are selfish and unnecessary purposes, many of them, that serve no other purpose than to mess up the show. The Courier believes the funds named are those which really deserve united support in the fullest possible measure.

Now comes the American Bible Society, asking for a trainload of gold to buy Bibles for the soldiers. Tighten up your purse strings, friends. More Liberty loans are coming; you can buy thrift stamps every day in the week; the Y. M. C. A. will need more of your money. The so-called Bible society is a group of polite gentlemen who publish Bibles for profit. They want every soldier to have the Holy book so that the society may get the profit from the sale. That is honorable, isn't it? And its plea has been voiced by hundreds of unsuspecting clergymen.

A soldier in camp or trench or a sailor on the high seas has no time while on duty to read the Bible. When he has idle moments The Book is provided in numbers by the Y. M. C. A. building or dug out. If the Bible society would give its books to every soldier as a medium for stopping the flying bullet why not buy the men a pack of cards? They would be even more effective for the purpose than the Bible and just as useful to a man with a gun at his shoulder in a dank trench at a cost vastly less. Don't duplicate the purpose of your donations.

The Soldiers' Recreation fund is another monument to greed, if not graft. Paid officers get most of the average fund to which we are asked to donate and the man behind the gun sees only the shadow of its blessing. When Portland entertained the soldiers at Christmas time did the recreation fund pay the bill? Soldiers are not on leave long enough to enjoy a recreation center and when they are the recreation fund doesn't pay the cost of the special entertainment provided.

We are asked for a million dollars or more to stamp out vice in and about army camps. Notice, do you not, how General Greene stamped out vice about Camp Lewis. Simple military orders did the work without a cent of cost. The city of Seattle can clean up or lose the soldiers' presence. Oregon does not want to pay to clean out Washington's filth when General Greene and his like can handle the matter without expense.

The Salvation Army wants a million. That would be highly deserving were there not greater needs for our money.

There are a number of organizations working at cross-purposes to the Y. M. C. A., and some of them have been officially recognized by the government. If there is a Christianity for mankind, cannot one organization represent Jew and Gentile, Catholic and Protestant? That would not be the Christianity of government. If there is a Christianity for the money we give to unworthy funds the less we can afford for the worthy ones. We should confine our efforts to worthy channels. This sermon is for those whose giving is limited. Those who have wealth will waste their money anyhow, so let them squander it as they

will. The rest of us must make every penny count and if we throw our dollars to the birds the pigs may get them.

THE PRICE OF PEACE

"Let there be no misunderstanding. Our present and immediate task is to win the war, and nothing shall turn us aside from it until it is accomplished. Every power and resource we possess, whether of men, of money, or of material, is being devoted to that purpose until it is achieved. * * *

"We shall regard the war as won only when the German people say to us, through properly accredited representatives, that they are ready to agree to a settlement based upon justice and the reparation of the wrongs their rulers have done. * * *

"When this intolerable thing, this German power, is, indeed, defeated and the time comes that we can discuss peace—when the German people have spokesmen whose words we can believe and when those spokesmen are ready in the name of their people to accept the common judgment of the nations as to what shall henceforth be the basis of law and of covenant for the life of the world—we shall be willing and glad to pay the full price for peace and pay it ungrudgingly. We know what that price will be. It will be full, impartial justice—justice done at every point and to every nation that the final settlement must affect, our enemies as well as our friends."—Statements from Washington.

Happy New Year.

This "Merry Christmas and Happy New Year" greeting does seem to warm up the soul.

It doesn't take any great brain to figure that hundreds of people will write it "Jan. 1, 1917" next Tuesday.

Pardon us while we pause to remark that the past week or so has provided excellent weather for ducks.

The more we see of some of the metropolitan daily papers the better we appreciate rural journalism and the men behind it.

After all it is odd how, regardless of creed or color, people so generally open their hearts and their minds in the united observance of the Christmas.

When one has properly answered a draft questionnaire he has hauled the family ghost from the closet for all time and the roots of the family tree are thereafter exposed to the elements.

Merely as a gentle reminder, The Courier might suggest that its subscription books will greet belated subscribers with open arms and thankfulness on, after or before January 1, 1918.

Only a few generations ago a boy of eight handled a heavy musket as effectively against the red skin as did his elders. In this generation a 15-year-old lad is not responsible with the possession of a toy gun. Are we to consider from this that civilization is advancing?

What can we expect of our children when school boards set the example for conduct that was evidenced in Clackamas county recently? The school board, of all community organizations, should be composed of the most large hearted, most broad minded men and women obtainable.

A man in Oregon City was in the sixth grade of school in the United States before he had been taught by the schools, the words or tunes of "The Star Spangled Banner," or "America," yet he was taught "The Watch on the Rhine" in every class from the first grade to the eighth. Did German school children sing our

national anthems as a part of their regular or special work at any time in German school history?

"The Annual Xmas Shopping Number" of the Oregon City Courier is just that—a buyers' guide for the holiday season, and, judging by the stores represented in its unusual size of 24 pages, Oregon City people had little need to come to the metropolitan for the good things for Xmas (which is the Courier's and lazy people's way of misspelling a day sacred to dignity as well as jollity).—The Oregonian.

The Courier joins the Oregonian in abhorrence for the contraction of the spelling of Christmas and calls attention to the fact that "Xmas" does not appear in The Courier except in headlines where the proper word is not possible.

GOOD OLD WINTER

Cold Wave Makes Humanity Warm Up to Every One.

Zero Temperature Brings Out Diverse-Fied Discussion Around the Stoves In Favorite Meeting Places.

After all there's something fine about a human's about a good stinging cold snap. It seems to bring us closer together and cause a friendlier feeling all around. Most any of us are willing to let bygones be bygones before we get a square from home on a zero moraine, for there's something about a cold wave that makes us want to warm up to the first fellow we meet. We just seem to feel that we must release everything on our minds that's pleasant and frothy, says Abe Martin, in the Indianapolis News.

Around the grocery store, in the close, ill-smelling depot, in the stuffy crowded car, or wherever folks are wont to huddle, like marooned sailors, in zero weather, we find the best of fellowship. We hear of old winters in the seventies; we hear a lively exchange of views on the probable extent of the cold weather; we learn the inner workings of the homes of others; we're brought face to face with resurrected overcoats and muffs of doubtful vintage.

We gather highly illuminative information regarding the respective claims of the various heating systems; we learn valuable facts about the heat units of this coal or that; we find out who gets up first in the homes of others; we hear pitiful stories of destitution; we learn the thickness of our neighbors' underwear; an almost allus there's somebody in the crowd who has just received a letter from a friend in Florida and we gain much interesting information about the climatic conditions in the Southland.

"We burned twenty-one tons of coal so far and we have 'live in the dinin' room," says the blustering little man, with an icicle dangling from his goatee.

"We heat our house here and we're on our seventh ton of coal," says the tall, faithful clerk with a purple nose. "I let my wife run the furnace," says the frail bookkeeper with watery eyes.

"The only trouble we have is short in hot air in a southwest bedroom," says a tall man of commandant appearance and buckled overshoes.

"I stayed at Aunt Ella's house last night. She has 'th' stoumest heat an' her house is just like toast," says the narrow-gauged stenographer, with bare powdered throat, transparent shins and ponderous goat muffs.

"If you're goin' to heat a house, you've got to burn coal. I don't care whether it's steam or hot water or hot air, you've got to loosen up an' pile on the coal. I never knowed that till this winter. We used to spend our winter evenings in the 'nicked theaters,' an' an ole rumbustious place."

"Our friend is right. You've got to have a fire. You can't put out a fire. Economical stuff ever made a good cup of coffee. There's two things you've got to use liberally if you want results, an' them's coal an' coffee," says a fierce looking man with thin red whiskers and a protruding fur cap.

But zero weather clumps an' crowds are allus friendly, for they seems to be something in the cold, blin' winds that warns us to keep off of politics an' confine our observations to the more homely topics.

Speed Was Justified.

Police magistrates have heard that stereotyped excuse of speeders—that something must be wrong with their speedometer—so often when they are haled to court for stepping too hard on the gas that they welcome any new stuff. relates a New York correspondent. "You are charged with speeding 28 miles an hour," said the magistrate of the traffic court to a road-runner. "That, sir, is a very dangerous speed. Death and disaster lurk where a motorist travels with such disregard of the law." "Now, judge," said the man at the bar, looking into the eyes of the magistrate like a spanked baby waiting for the next blow. "I had heard where I could buy some sugar, and I was in a hurry to get there." There wasn't much the magistrate could do in the face of that, so he fined the defendant \$25.

Stock Food Substitutes.

In the search for substitutes for live stock food a German scientist made analytical tests of materials suggested for the purpose. He found dried rhubarb leaves better than hay as a fodder for hogs; kelp may be fed to cattle and pigs; but it has little nutritive value; ground straw, which is selling at from 28 to 50 marks the quintal, is not good for any animal, nor are ground pea pods. He advises against cornstalks and cobs. The seeds of beets are nutritive; those of parsley too exciting; those of raisins, if ground before the oil is extracted, are as good as hay. Oil cakes made from beech or other nuts are excellent for cattle.

About the State

Resume of the News of the Week from All Parts of Oregon

Salem.—Alleging shortcomings on the part of the Warren construction company, State Highway Engineer Nunn last week ordered cancelled the two contracts held by that company for macadamizing portions of the lower Columbia river highway. One of the contracts was for a section highway between Westport and Stevenson, a distance of 15.5 miles, and would cost approximately \$111,295. The other was from the Clatsop county line to Clatskanie, a distance of 5.3 miles, and estimated cost was \$36,474. For weeks the highway department has been having much trouble with the company over payrolls and accounts submitted to the state for payment. Mr. Nunn includes in his notice to the company eight reasons for canceling contract. Mr. Nunn stated that his department will take over the work and complete it by direct force account.

Corvallis.—What action the farmers may take toward the non-partisan organization for Oregon at the coming farmers' week at the O. A. C. December 31 to January 5, is a question that many in this and other counties in the state are asking, and but few are answering. However, there is little question but what the matter will be brought up during the sessions and some action forced on it.

Eugene.—Douglas Campbell of Eugene was elected president of the Lane County Horticultural society at its annual meeting, held here last week. C. H. Sedgwick of Creswell was chosen secretary-treasurer. C. O. Holl, general manager of the Eugene Fruit Growers' association's canneries in Eugene, Junction City and Creswell, reported that the output of these plants during the last season was 25 per cent greater than in 1916, despite the shortage in some crops. Many of the speakers expressed optimism over the prospects for the fruit industry.

Salem.—J. W. Brewer, farm help specialist for Oregon for the department of agriculture, is here working in conjunction with Labor Commissioner Hoff and his assistant, Lester B. Davis, in coordinating and combining the work for next year to be carried on in furnishing the farmers of the state with a sufficient supply of help when it is needed. The services of county agricultural agents and of members of the grange and farmers' unions are being enlisted. A questionnaire will be prepared which will be sent throughout the state to those in a position to furnish the information desired. A complete statistical record of crop and labor conditions will be kept in the office of Mr. Hoff.

Baker.—Every one of the 71 residents of the town of Izo, in Grant county, has joined the Red Cross, it was reported from there last week.

Wheeler.—Storms have caused great damage at the government jetty at the mouth of Nehalem bay, examination showed. Thirty bents of the jetty tramway were washed into the channel, carrying the pile driver, eight rock cars and the tender launch with them. In several other places on the jetty one or more bents were carried away.

Pendleton.—The barn, cook house, 12 head of horses, one cow, and all harness and farm implements owned by C. A. Barrett on one of his Pine creek ranches were totally destroyed by fire last week, says a letter received here by Henry Taylor from Mr. Barrett. No insurance was carried. It is believed that the fire was of incendiary origin. Stores of hay and grain were also consumed by the flames.

Salem.—A fire in the boiler room of the state prison Friday night while many of the prisoners and guards were enjoying a moving picture show in the prison auditorium, threatened the institution and made hard work necessary to extinguish the flames. A guard on the wall fired several shots to attract attention to the fire.

Astoria.—Delmer C. Stickler, who has been held in the county jail for several weeks in default of \$1000 bonds to await the action of the circuit court grand jury on a charge of stealing a boat, was released Friday by Justice of the Peace Carney, on the recommendation of the district attorney. The reason this action was taken was because Stickler has been called under the draft at Goldendale, Wash. The authorities believed that the man would be of greater service in the army than serving a term in jail.

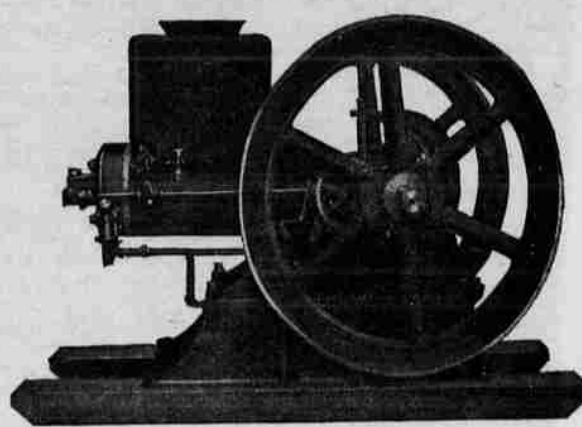
Carlton.—A double explosion without a fire which destroyed the grain elevator of the Johnson Elevator company and 6000 bushels of grain which it contained here early Sunday. The estimated loss is \$22,000. The force of the explosion blew the roof completely off the elevator. After the fire the safe was found to have been drilled, but not opened. A. L. Johnson, owner of the elevator, and Sheriff W. G. Henderson, who came here to investigate, said the explosion and fire were clearly incendiary.

Portland.—Oregon will promise Chairman Hurley of the United States shipping board that 150 wooden hulls can be completed in 1918 for government purposes in yards along the Willamette and Columbia rivers and those at Oregon coast ports. On a basis of 3500 tons deadweight for each ship, that will mean 525,000 tons or 150,000 tons more of wooden ships than Puget Sound and Grays Harbor yards have promised.

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Pendleton.—Instructions received by Superintendent E. L. Swartzlander of the Umatilla Indian reservation require that all persons leasing Indian land must adhere to the 800-acre maximum. Eight or 10 farmers previously were permitted to exceed this limit. They will be required to cut their acreage this fall or next spring.

Roseburg.—What is believed to be the first action by any county court in the United States to assist the nation in the prosecution of the war was taken by the Douglas county court, when an order was issued placing \$50,000 in the 1918 budget for the purchase of Liberty bonds. When the bonds mature the principal and interest will be used to construct a new courthouse and jail.

Salem.—Governor Withycombe announced Saturday that instead of urging the war department to remove the unhusked coast artillery detachments now at Fort Stevens, Ore., to Vancouver barracks, as requested by the war auxiliaries council here Friday, he had suggested to the people of Astoria that they immediately provide the troops with shelter and adequate accommodations. This the Astorians readily agreed to do. There are approximately 1300 men in the coast artillery at Fort Stevens, the governor said, and the Vancouver barracks are overcrowded now.

Gold Hill.—Benton Bowers of Ashland, member of the state line board, met with the officials of the Southern Pacific company to establish the site on the railway for terminal grounds of the aerial tramway leading from the quarry site to the railway one mile below Gold Hill.

Hood River.—J. L. Allen, former pastor of the Heights Baptist church, who was arrested Wednesday charged with setting fire to a house leased at Cascade Locks, was bound over Friday to action of the March grand jury. Bail was increased from \$500 to \$1000.

Airline.—With the opening of the Valley & Siletz railway, extending from Independence to Vale, Ore., on January 1, the development of a rich timber district will be formally commenced. The first outflow of big logs started late this summer and made its way through Airline, Monmouth, Dallas and thence to the valley mills. The timbers, although

marking the very beginning of the new traffic, were some of the finest that have made an appearance in Polk county.

Eugene.—Interest in plans for the standardization of the potato crop in Lane county is to be promoted by the Eugene-Springfield Potato association, formed at a meeting held in Eugene last week. The officers of the association are: E. E. Morrison of Springfield, president; George T. Hall of Eugene, vice president, and C. T. Jones of Eugene, secretary-treasurer. The purpose of the association is to establish in the minds of buyers from other sections of the country a confidence in the Willamette valley potato.

Astoria.—To be suddenly transformed from a barber at \$18 per week, to a man of wealth was the experience of A. S. Haddix, employed in a local shop. News of his good fortune came in a telegram which said he was heir to an estate of \$100,000, left by an uncle who died last Tuesday at Houston, Texas. Haddix, who is a cousin of Deputy Collector Haddix, has been here but three weeks, and will leave next Sunday for Texas to administer the estate.

Salem.—After years of litigation and investigation, the state water board entered the final decree in the adjudication of water rights on the Silvers river in Harney county. There were 203 claimants and 67,000 acres of land involved. The largest claimant is the Pacific Live Stock company, which opposed adjudication and fought the water board in the courts.

Hillsboro.—After a search covering four days hope of finding alive John Pieren, aged resident of the Swiss settlement at Helvetia, has been abandoned. Pieren left his home a week ago to visit John Ritter, who lives near the summit of the mountain, separating the valley from the Columbia basin. He started for home at 4 p. m., after inquiring regarding a short cut, and has not been seen since.

Milton.—At a meeting of several prosperous and influential farmers and other interested parties last week in Milton plans were outlined and discussed regarding a flour mill and elevator which will probably be erected in the city before another harvest. At this meeting was Mr.

Finley, a millwright; Mr. Campbell, elevator man, and Mr. Smith of the Tum-Lum Lumber company, who explained the advantages of the elevator system and also made estimates as to the probable cost.

SCHOOL GETS FLAG

Sixty Four Pupils, Present and Past, Have Joined U. S. Forces

The Rooters' club, a new student organization at the Oregon City high school, Friday presented to the school a service flag bearing 64 stars for the boys who have left the school to enter the army or navy. The number includes graduates and others. Lawrence Hull, acting for the club, presented the flag, and W. L. Arant, principal of the school, accepted it. The ceremonies were accompanied by a musical program in which Miss Elizabeth Lewis and Miss Esther Staats figured. Miss Roberta Schuebel, a graduate of the local high school and now a student at the state university, talked to the pupils. Schools here closed yesterday for the holidays and will reopen on January 2.

TOM SINNOTT ILL

Youth Stricken While on Duty with Navy Recruiting Station

Thomas J. Sinnott, son of Mr. and Mrs. A. M. Sinnott and a yeoman in the United States navy in charge of the Spokane, Wash., recruiting station, was carried off the train here Friday morning and taken in an ambulance to the home of his parents. The young man is suffering from rheumatism and has been in a serious condition for some weeks. He has been unable to travel and Spokane doctors finally made him as comfortable as possible for the trip that seemed necessary. The young man was considered out of danger a few days ago and was coming home to recuperate. He has suffered a relapse, however. He is rapidly regaining his health at home.

Housewives, Attention!

The next time you make a pumpkin pie, don't make a crust to hold it. Instead, grease your pie tin well, then line it with a layer of corn-meal about a sixteenth of an inch thick, pour in your pumpkin filling and bake. You will find this conservation a saving of time as well as a saving of wheat, also tempting to the taste, as well as patriotic.



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